



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE **#10**
Oct 2023

COMING EVENTS

OCTOBER

5th Monthly Meeting
7th Central Coast Workshop
8th Make-a-Wish
11th Committee Meeting
18th Joadja Distillery Tour
21st Mid-Nth Coast Gathering

NOVEMBER

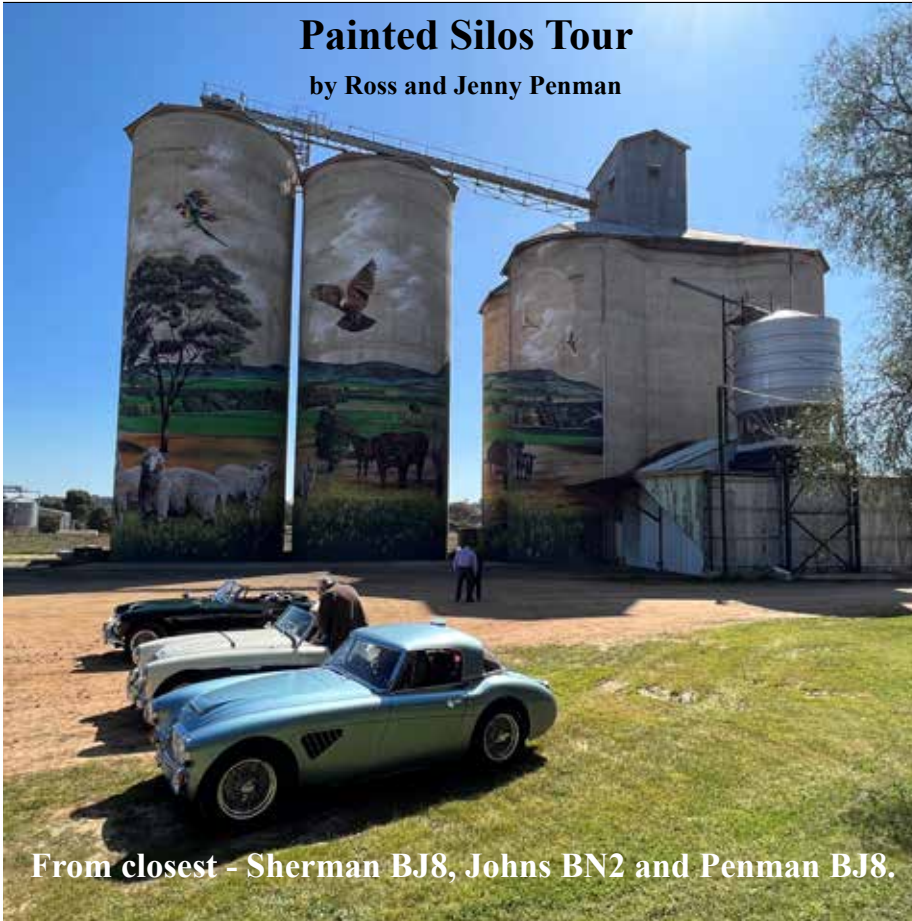
2nd Annual General Meeting
4th Central Coast Workshop
8th Committee Meeting
15th S'ern H'lands & I'warra
Gathering

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Painted Silos Tour

by Ross and Jenny Penman



From closest - Sherman BJ8, Johns BN2 and Penman BJ8.

Sunday afternoon 3rd September, saw us set off in our BJ8 for Goulburn to join the Painted Silos Tour in memory of Terry Bancroft who had organised the tour prior to his passing. We couldn't believe our eyes while on the M7, John and Judy Sherman in their BJ8 caught up with us, so we travelled together to Goulburn to stay the night.

On arrival, we decided to go up to the lookout to view the Rocky Hill War Memorial, as over all the times we had visited Goulburn we hadn't been there. It is a beautiful memorial to those who served in The Great War 1914-18.

John and Judy visited Don Read, whom they found in great spirits.

Several of the group stayed the night in Goulburn prior to going on to Harden-Murrumburrah for the first silo of the trip. Here we met up with most of the group before going onto Grenfell and lunch.

It was wonderful that Pat Bancroft could be with us, thanks to Alan Mitchell, for kindly driving her. Other members of our group were Ernie and Merle Clark, Colin and Delwyn Goldsmith, Larry and Helen Johns, Ray and Muriel Roberts along with their daughter Janine, Doug and Pamela Ross, John and Judy Sherman, Neville Stirton and friend Carol Brown, and John and Fran Thornton besides us.



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Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

2023 - 2024

I think I have already lamented the fact that 2023 is quickly disappearing into 2024. This was further made apparent when I went shopping with my bride, something that I very rarely do and which has mutual agreement. Stepping into Spotlight I was dumbfounded at the array of material to celebrate Halloween which was six weeks away at that stage and then stopping at Aldi was presented with all of the Christmas fare.

So, what does that all mean for our club?

Next month, November 2nd will be our AGM after the general meeting (which is two days after Halloween). This is your annual opportunity to nominate and/or volunteer and vote for one of the positions on the committee. Please remember that nominations for the positions need to be submitted prior to the AGM as set out in our



constitution. At the AGM voting will occur for those positions where nominations have been received prior to the AGM. The only nominations that will be accepted from the floor are for those positions where no nominations have been submitted prior to the AGM. Watch your inboxes for further information shortly and please have your say in who you want to lead our club.

And then it was Christmas. This year our Christmas party will be held on Thursday 7th December at the Strathfield Golf Club. Put the date in your calendar and make sure that you RSVP via the website so that you will be fed and wa-

tered. More info to come so look out for it.

153624

These numbers are etched into my mind at present. To bore you with more detail, my Austin-Healey has developed an intermittent miss, which my mate Colin Rule thought could be due to a cracked distributor cap. Knowing that my distributor cap indeed did have a crack which I'd super glued and taped many, many months ago I decided that perhaps the time had come to get a new one. So, an order for new cap, leads, rotor

Cont' page 5

COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave.,
Wyoming NSW 2250
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
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hedli@tpg.com.au

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joea6@bigpond.com

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Regalia - Colin Rule
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Technical Officer - Greg Strange
02 9319 2299
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Alan Jones (D),
Warwick Sell (D), Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick
Quinn, Terry Bancroft (D), Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the
Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
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Greetings and welcome to the October 2023 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and I am sure there will be a few words and photos within that will be of interest.

The 2023 British Display Day has come and gone. Sorry to say that due to family reasons we couldn't be there. Held on a perfect Sydney spring day it attracted hundreds of British car enthusiasts and of course their cars. There is a photo report starting on page 14 and thank you to Jenny Penman and Julie Lee for sending in the photos.

You would have noticed from the first page that the Silo Tour is featured. Organised by our sadly departed life member Terry Bancroft, the event turned out to well enjoyed by everyone who toured. Thanks again to Jenny Penman for the photos and also the words.

Thank you! Thank you! To Ian Richter and Allan Whitehouse for

being kind to the readers of the Flat Chat Newsletter. Once again Ian has kept us up to date with the restoration of his 100 (although he says there hasn't been much done) and Allan for telling us about a recent trip he and Jo made to the Hunter Valley with fellow members Carol and Russell Kelly. However, read carefully as there is a bite in the tail, as the speedo of his BJ7 deciding not to work.

Thank you too Andrew James for sending in photos of his new waterproof cover for his 100/6.

So there is lots to read, plus all the reports that everyone can't do without, including Jim's frustrations caused by a faulty distributor cap.

Please have a look at page 6/7 and 18, for the details on the Make-A-Wish Sydney Car Show that is being held this coming Sunday. It's for a great cause and if you

have the time come along for a looksee. Plus on page 19 there is a preview of the next Charlie's Run.

Probably in around seven more sleeps! The Quinn Austin-Healey will be piggybacking on yet another tilt tray and finding its way from Platinum Smash Repairs to its converted milking shed that houses the Quinn Healey and Austin-Healey. The damaged front shroud has been repaired, refinished and looking pretty good. Once here there are a number of mechanical bits and pieces to attend to, followed by the trim. Then it will be multiple trial runs until I feel comfortable with taking it out on the road. There was a time when I wouldn't hesitate to drive it anywhere and hopefully that will not be far away again.

I trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. Please do send me some words and photos of what you have been up to.



Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club

Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm

Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 9 September 2023

Meeting commenced at 7:35pm.

Venue - via Zoom

ATTENDEES

Bruce Ewan, Chris Hatch, Julie Lee, Jim Phillips, Patrick Quinn, Ian Richter, Colin Rule, Greg Strange.

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

N/A

APOLOGIES

Denis Kasza, Garry Lee.

MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 3 August 2023, as published in the September 2023 issue of *Flat Chat*, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Via Pamela Ross who was on the Painted Silos Tour, apparently all three Austin-Healeys on the run had behaved so far, but the group had been having trouble finding places to eat!



Jim advised that unfortunately he hadn't made much progress on the constitution while in Flowerpot recently.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Julie provided an update on (non-spam) emails received. She also mentioned that with the increase in the number of social events, keeping the points score up to date was becoming very time-consuming, particularly when she wasn't provided with attendee details for the events.

TREASURER'S REPORT

In Jenny's absence, Jim reported on the Club's bank account balances, and income and expenditure.

Treasurer's Report @ 31 August 2023

Bank account balances

Term Deposit	\$70,000.00	
Cash Reserve	\$22,132.77	(Interest \$29.09)
Charlies Run	\$1,844.14	(Interest \$0.01)
Debit Card	\$303.82	
Main Account	\$31,384.55	

Income

Membership	\$1,220.00
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Expenses

InDesign	\$59.98
Social	\$87.40
Regalia	\$50.00
Square Service Fee	\$4.40
National Assn. Magazine	\$2,025.00
National Rally	\$29.85

MEMBERSHIP

Jim provided an update on new member activity. Associate membership had been approved for Keith & Amanda Tulloch and Anthony & Tanya Papandrea. These would both go to the next Committee meeting for approval of full membership. A couple more members had also renewed their memberships.

SOCIAL SECRETARIES' REPORT

Bruce ran through the upcoming social calendar, noting that most events were attracting good attendance.

On a very sad note, Jim advised that Greg Tucker, from the Central West Chapter, had passed away recently.

There was discussion on what constituted Club-sanctioned events, which had an impact on whether members needed to fill in their logbooks when driving their cars, plus whether the event might be covered by the Club's insurance.

Essentially, Club-sanctioned events (i.e. approved by the Committee) would be organised in advance and advertised in Flat Chat and on the website. It was recognised that Club members might organise informal gatherings from time to time, but it needed to be clear that these were exactly that – informal gatherings.



WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim noted that there were still a few outstanding issues to be sorted out.

Julie raised that several complaints had been made on the Facebook page about new members of that page advertising products (t-shirts) for sale. This wasn't the purpose of the page, so it was agreed that any such offenders would be removed from the group.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

Jim advised that Pamela had sent a get-well card to Lehmann Bloom following his recent major surgery.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick advised that Flat Chat had gone out earlier that day. He thanked Ian Richter for his cover story.

REGISTRAR



Historic Vehicle Registration News

Patrick had received applications for five new cars on Conditional Registration, including two from Queensland (connected to the two new members).

HISTORIAN

No Report.

LIBRARIAN

No Report.

President's Message continued
button, points and condenser were sent to AH Spares with the parcel arriving a few days later. Geoff Smith was co-opted into demonstrating how to go about replacing a distributor cap at the Central Coast Chapter workshop. Off came the old cap (153624 actually it was 123456) but alas, when fitting the leads, it was discovered that the new cap was defective and needed to be replaced. While putting the old cap back on, 153624, the crack became a hole, so unserviceable and the Austin-Healey not going anywhere. The only cap that Col had that would fit was off the Bond 3000 so off it came and was installed, 153624, which got me home but also demonstrated that the problem wasn't the cap as it still existed. A few days later prior to jetting off o/s, Geoff did some

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/ SPARE PARTS

Nothing to Report.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

No report.

CMC REPORT

No Report.

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

No Report.

CSCA REPORT

No Report.

REGALIA

Colin mentioned that he'd sold three windscreens that day and Greg talked about Bugeye windscreens.

SHOW & TELL

N/A

GENERAL BUSINESS

Chris thanked the Club for the ability to purchase items, e.g. the windscreens, but wondered how Club members got visibility of parts that might be available. Jim mentioned that items could be advertised on the website. Colin mentioned that he'd been thinking of sending some stuff up to Chris to sell on behalf of the Club. Jim added that the Club could also send some of the library books to the Chapters to make available to local members.

Meeting concluded at 8:35pm.

tuning of the engine to try to find the cause which involved replacing the rotor button and the ignition points so yep! again 153624.

Three weeks later the cap arrived. Although the original was sent Express Post, the replacement came Par Avion and after raiding the tools at the men's shed for a thin screwdriver I attached the new leads and proceeded to replace the Bond 3000 cap. All done, 153624 but the engine wouldn't fire. I forgot 0 (or is that 7?), the high-tension lead to the coil. Attach that and it still doesn't fire. Check around the bench and discover the little carbon bit on a spring. Once more remove the cap, fit the carbon piece and 153624 it fires. I think I should have a four-cylinder engine.



Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

All British Day 2023 at The Kings School Parramatta was spectacular. After three long years a really memorable experience was created, proving once again this event is the best of the Sydney car shows.

Sydney turned out one of those absolutely stunning spring days for which we are world renowned. A perfect day for top-down enjoyment.

While a little warm in the middle of the day, blue skies and a gentle breeze that wafted over the fields, delivered a really enjoyable experience.

British cars, many being the most revered and respected globally, brought large crowds, with all the expected joy. Morris, Jaguar, Rolls-Royce, Bentley, TVR, Austin, Land Rover, Aston Martin, Triumph, MG, Austin-Healey, Lotus, Morgan, Bristol, Lagonda, Alvis, as well as assorted military vehicles plus a few others.

The top field is reserved for the most respected marques, key exhibits and the best of the best. Austin-Healey Owners Club of NSW was on the top field and delivered a great turn out with some of the most unusual and rare cars on display.

Our turnout of 21 cars attracted a lot of attention, dwarfed by the presence of over 200 Jaguars, yet still dominant. A lot of that attention goes down to the Gerry Corker design, never bettered, plus the rarity, which was shown by the lack of focus on Jaguars, which seemed to be dime-a-dozen.

Represented in the Disney Pixar animation, few would have seen in real life an Austin Metropolitan or the American version, the Nash or Hudson Metropolitan, that came off the same Longbridge assembly line where Austin-Healeys were built. With single digit versions of these cars in Australia, our club had both, convertible and hard top versions.

Cars on display included:- Julie & Garry Lee – BJ8, Mark McAllan – BJ8, Lew McAllan – Mk1 BN7, Amer & Margaret Khoury – MGB (fresh from resto-

ration), Bruce Ewan – Jaguar E-type, Greg Strange & Dianne Lawlor – Sprite Mk III, Neville Stirton – Mk1 BT7, Rob Hosking – BJ8, Damien Carrick – BJ8, Richard Horwood – Mk2 BN7, Ronnie Strange – Mk2 BT7, Jim Phillips – BN4, David McIntyre – BJ8 (fresh from restoration), Vince Cessario – BJ8, Ross & Jenny Penman – BJ8, George Goodare – 100M, John & Melissa Oppenheim – BJ8, Richard Lloyd – BN2 and Denis Kasza & Susie Doctor – Austin Westminster.

Non-Members included Laura Rafferty – Austin Metropolitan, Chris Shead – Nash Metropolitan, Nagy Khoury – TR4, Morgan Ayling (Mark McAllan's son-in-law), and Peter from Men's Shed (with Jim Phillips)

Organisers of All British Day have to be congratulated for the well organised event. Entry was simple and easy. There were no delays. Plenty of volunteers and marshals guiding cars to the allocated positions with efficiency.

Food and coffee options were good, although with only one place to purchase limited, demonstrated by the lines of people wishing to partake. A formal thank you will be formulated by the club and forwarded.

Hoping for 2024, we are able to bring together a larger gathering, more of the club members and once again can wow the crowds. For 2024, I plan to coordinate music and the appropriate paraphernalia to theme our display.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Central Coast Chapter

7th October - Please see pages 8-9

Make-A-Wish Sydney Car Show

Date: Sunday 8th October 2023

Location: 85 Waterloo Rd, Macquarie Park – please see next page and 18

Make A Wish Central Sydney Chapter Fundraising

Visitors: Donation on entry

Car display: \$100 Tax Deductable donation

The first Make-A-Wish Sydney Car Show held in 2022 was a roaring success with over 130 cars, thousands of visitors and lots of extremely rare, unusual, interesting and exclusive cars.

Brian Levy a long-time strong member of Austin Healey Owners Club of NSW, and daughter Emma, are the creators of this event.

Make-A-Wish is a well-known and highly respected charity, that funds wishes for sick children. Make-A-Wish deliver the unusual, the incredible, the dreams that support and enhance the lives of ill children for a better future.

Over the years Make-A-Wish have made unicorns fly, sent kids to the moon and, together with #WishForce, are on a mission to grant a wish for every eligible child. Wishes have a remarkable, uplifting and positive impact that extends far beyond the wish itself.

Many thanks to Emma Levy for sending the following.

The Sydney Car Show is back for its second year on 8th October. This event was curated by Emma (President of Central Sydney Branch Make-A-Wish) and Bryan (member of the Austin-Healey Owners Club) last year with the support of other AHOC members and Make-A-Wish volunteers. For the 2022 event and again this year, we are being supported by 'Goodman' who donate the venue for us to use and provide staff support where needed. This event has allowed us to bring together a community of those who love cars

while raising money to grant wishes to children who look forward to them for many months prior during often difficult times in their lives. This year is even more special as there will be a wish child at the event who loves cars!

Last year's event raised over \$22,000 and showcased approximately 140 cars from 1929-2021.

We already have seven AHOC members registered, so come and join us! Please call either Emma (0401 348 210) or Bryan (0413 063 213) if you have any further questions.

Website - <https://fundraise.makeawish.org.au/event/sydney-car-show/home>

Photos from 2022 event - <https://www.sydneylens.com.au/Automotive/Make-A-Wish/Make-A-Wish-car-show-Rosbery-2022/i-Q5b9ctp>

Facebook - <https://www.facebook.com/MAWAustCentralSydney>

Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

Joadja Distillery Tour and Tasting

Wednesday 18th October 2023

Please see page 13 for details.

Mid-North Coast Chapter

Saturday 21st October 2023.

Membership Report -

Christine Lyttle

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

We have two new memberships that were accepted as members at our last committee meeting (thanks Jim for looking after this on my behalf while I was absent) they are:- Keith and Amanda Tulloch from Rothbury with a 1965 3000 MKIII BJ8 and Anthony and Tanya Papandrea from Collaroy with a 1966 3000 MKIII BJ8.

We welcome Keith and Amanda and Anthony and Tanya to the AHOC and hopefully they will attend a meeting or event shortly.

Now that I have returned from my holiday in the USA and Canada, I will look at the online membership form and the membership cards that should be available through our website. Will let you know as soon as these are available.

Don't forget if you change your email address, street address or your car details, please update them online through the website as you have access through your membership. Should you have any issues accessing, then contact either Jim Phillips our web-master or myself.

Please let me know if you have any questions and will get back to you with a reply.



Cont' from P1

Besides the Shermans and ourselves in BJ8s, Larry and Helen Johns were in their newly acquired BN2.

We all had a wonderful time travelling to various silos and other places of interest at different times, meeting up at night for dinner. Throughout we stayed in West Wyalong, Dubbo, Quirindi, Gunnedah and six of us in Wallerawang after visiting the silo in Portland, before driving home.

The silos we visited after Harden and Grenfell, were located at Weethalle, Dunedoo, Merriwa, Quirindi, Barraba (the furthest north we travelled), Gunnedah and Portland. The paintwork on the silos was amaz-



On arriving at Gunnedah, we noticed our rear wheel was going slowly flat, thanks to Colin Goldsmith we found a nail had caused the problem. The tyre was changed and repaired the following morning while having breakfast.

Travelling at this time of year was perfect, as the weather was glorious, except for Friday when it rained part of the morning, turning cold when we reached Portland. The blossoms, canola and various other crops were plentiful.

Gunnedah was our last evening and Alan Mitchell arranged a room at a local hotel for dinner which was walking distance from the motel. While there,



ing, seeing the detail plus wondering how the artist was able to do it to the scale is incredible.

Some of us travelled on to Lake Cargelligo after Weethalle, where we had lunch overlooking the lake and seeing a painted water tank.

Terry had organised a great place for us all to stay in Quirindi, within was walking distance to the silo and the RSL Club for us to have dinner, only to discover the bistro was closed for the evening so most of us proceeded around to the Bowling Club for a lovely Chinese dinner. The weather was perfect for us to watch the light show at the silo. The light show was accompanied by sound and went for about 20 minutes.



Cont' from P8

we made a toast to Terry and there were some beautiful things said about him.

In total we travelled 2,222.5km. Many thanks to

Terry for organising such a fantastic time for us all, we are just sorry you were not with us, even though we felt that you were at times, especially when an extra wide load went past with an escort.



Standing L-R. Ernie Clark, Ray Roberts, John Sherman, Doug Ross, Helen Johns, Ross Penman, Pamela Ross, Larry Johns, Colin Goldsmith, John Thornton, Fran Thornton, Jenny Penman, Carol Brown, Alan Mitchell and Neville Stirton. Sitting L-R. Judy Sherman, Janine Hinton, Muriel Roberts, Pat Bancroft, Merle Clark and Delwyn Goldsmith. On the final evening at Gunnedah.

Chapter News

Central Coast Chapter Workshop

Saturday 2nd September

Good weather seems to be the norm for our Central Coast workshops with September 2nd definitely no exception. Another very good role up with 25 participants all eager to get involved with the morning's tasks.

We had 11 Austin-Healeys, two Sunbeam Alpines, an EH Holden, a 289 Falcon Futura Two-Door Coupe and a PRB Clubman. Another impressive display of our beloved classics.

The two main jobs to tackle were Larry John's new acquisition BN2. This was given a chassis clean and general tighten up of shocks absorbers, rear hubs and exhaust.

Our fearless president Jim Phillips BN4 had a little cough and few little pesky hick ups. Resident mechanic Geoff Smith took control of that task only to find the new distributor cap that Jim had purchased was faulty.

So to get him back on the road pronto, we tea leafed the distributor cap and leads of the Ross Bond 3000. Now Jim reckons he's laying rubber every time he takes off. That will stop soon because his replacement cap is on its way.

Following another very successful workshop morning we finished up with our traditional coffee, cookies and cake around 11 o'clock.



A very big welcome to our newbies, John Schoonbeek, son Josh and grandsons Caleb and Levi EH Holden, Greg Denning BJ8, Greg Strange and Dianne Lawlor. (above)

The other eager beavers were Richard Horwood, Julie Lee BJ8, Garry Lee Falcon 2 door Coupe, Helen Vance and Adam Lethlean BN7, Tony Ash Northern Rivers chapter well done Tony, Ian and Jenni Richter BJ7, Jim Phillips BN4, Damien Carrick BJ8, Roger Ramsay, Chris Jenkins BT7 MK1, Mark Kertly



Sunbeam Alpine, Richard Cardew Sunbeam Alpine, Larry Johns BN2, Geoff Smith PRB Clubman and Col and Kerrie 'yours truly' Rule BN2.

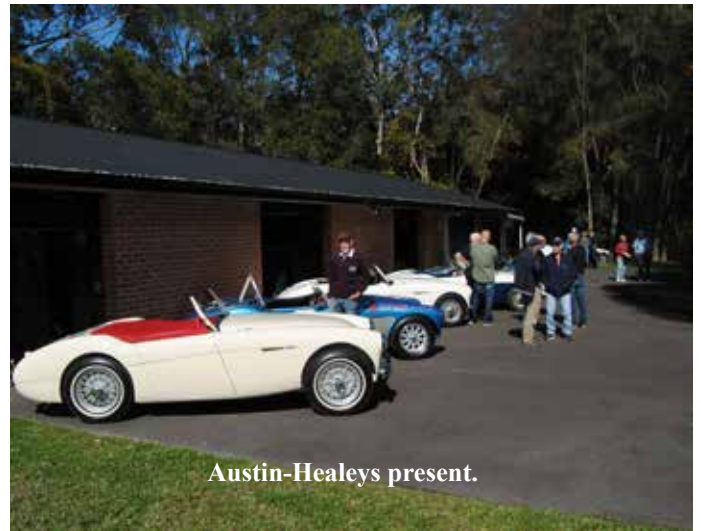
20 Fern Road Ourimbah. Starting 9am. You don't have to book in, just turn up. Oh, please bring a plate to share.

We are all looking forward to the October workshop which will be held at Ian and Jennie Richter's home,

Take care and Happy Healeyng. Col and Kerrie Rule.



Let's have a close look.



Austin-Healeys present.



The miss is missing.



Next gathering at Ian and Jennie Richter's home.



The October meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 5th at Strathfield Golf Club. You can also attend by Zoom. ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters “Long Lunch” Taralga

Wednesday 20th September 2023

David McIntyre took over the duties of meeting and greeting the Austin-Healey members for the fine sunny drive trip to Taralga. Fran and I were sorry to miss the event as we were away in Tasmania visiting family.



David and Michelle McIntyre, Colin Goldsmith, Greg and Kerri Poole

It was great to see the ever enthusiastic “day tripper” Colin Goldsmith make the drive to meet up with David and Michelle McIntyre at Sallys Corner for the trip across to Taralga, while our Central West members Greg and Kerri Poole took the opportunity to travel from Bathurst to meet up with the other club members.

David reports that the group had a good lunch at the Taralga Pub with a couple of hours chatting before they all headed for home.

John Thornton

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Mid-North Coast Chapter

Saturday 16th September 2023 Croki NSW

Present:- Chris Hatch, Al & Di Bryson and Phil & Anthea Lorking.

Apologies:- Tony Ash - on a mission to Melbourne to have his BT7 wire wheels repaired. Gel & Barb Roberson - Family Commitments.

Visitors:- John Spilsbury from Glen Innes in his BJ8 who arrived Wednesday afternoon, and after introducing himself, he went bush camping with his dog for a couple of days, returning for the meeting on Saturday.

Following last month’s discussion on balancing twin SUs, we went through the process of setting the mixtures. While there was more discussion with John than technical talk it was an interesting meeting.

Next month’s run on 21st October was discussed and to be advised. At this time it looks to be “Miss Nellie’s” at Kendall. Please call me on 0412 392 362 for details.

Cheers Phil Lorking

AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters
Joadja Distillery Tour and Tasting
Wednesday 18th October 2023



David McIntyre from the Southern Highlands has organised this day for us.

Joadja Distillery Tour and Tasting in the Southern Highlands.

A tour of the Historic site is NOT included

RSVP by 8th October.

Let me know even if you are only considering attending.

I need to give indication of numbers by the 8th October at latest

30 Spots Available

Meet 10:00am Surveyor General Inn, Old Hume Highway, Berrima

Then we have a 30 minutes' drive west of Berrima.

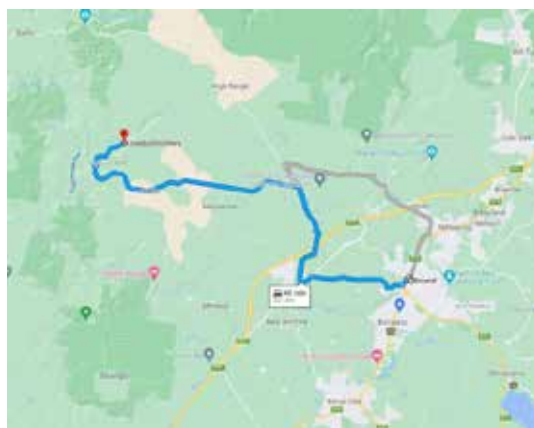
Joadja Distillery 1760 Joadja Road, JOADJA

SPECIAL OFFER: For our club they have waived their usual Cost of \$15 per head.

Note there is 5km of gravel road at the end as we arrive at the distillery



Our lunch is at the Surveyor General Inn, Berrima



Note the last 5km is a gravel road.

John Thornton

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Mobile: 0419 266 284

AHOC at the 2023 All British Day

After a four year break, many of us on 17 September headed to the sporting ovals of The Kings School at Parramatta to gather with fellow British car enthusiasts.



Thank you to Jenny Penman for these photos.

Thank you to Julie Lee for these photos from the All British Day





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Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

Some 11 years back, we bought a 1994 Toyota Hilux. It was on eBay for all of \$2,200 with 411,085k on the clock. Being an ex-rental vehicle, it had such conveniences as air conditioning, heater, 5-speed manual, CD/DVD player and radio. However, at that sort of \$\$\$ it was quite used around the edges. It even has a name. We called it 'Boats' because when we bought it, if you squinted, the registration looked a little like that. It's now NWD 977, the same registration that was on the Quinn Austin-Healey when it was at the Donald Healey Motor Company.

Since then, it's been used for moving all sorts of things.

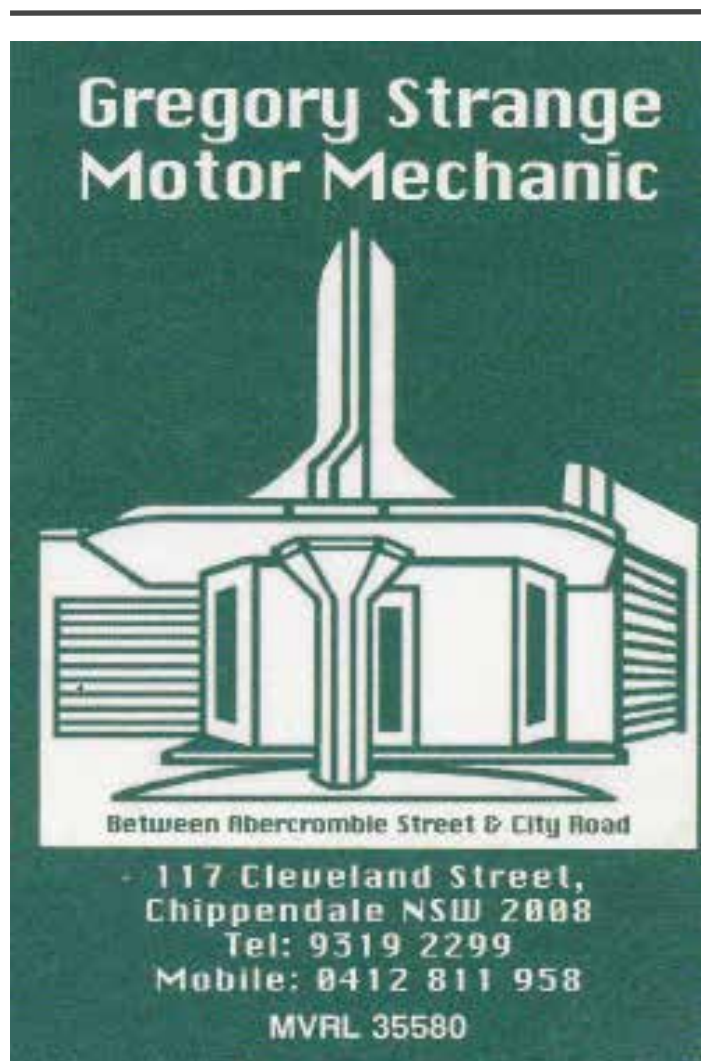
Rubbish to the tip, bringing home compost/soil/coo poo/gravel for the garden and timber for various around-the-house projects. At the moment it has a 1,000 litre water tank on its tray for picking up water and bringing it home. We are on tank water and going through a dry spell. Probably the most courageous thing it's done, was to carry six C-series engine blocks. It's been borrowed on numerous times by our grown-up children and been a super convenient vehicle. Through our ownership it has needed some mechanical repairs, but each year, it's sailed through its annual roadworthy inspection, while still certainly not concours. It's now just over 520,000k.

So what's that got to do with Conditional Registration? Next year it's 30 years old and will be conditionally registered while saving lots of CTP \$\$\$\$. Why! It's 30 years old! It's roadworthy! It's unmodified! And its owner is a member of a recognised car club. The only prerequisites for Historic Conditional Registration.

So you don't have to ask, the renewal steps are below.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.

DON'T FORGET THE STAMPED SELF-ADDRESSED ENVELOPE.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

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Maude - The BN1 Project - Snippet Five

By Ian Richter

When I click the send button to forward my latest project update on to Flat Chat Newsletter HQ, I always have some trepidation knowing full well that many readers are fully-fledged members or professionals of this "Restoration Party".

I'm a complete novice when it comes to restorations. Not having any experience, my effort falls into three categories, the good, the bad, and the ugly. Sounds a bit like the British motor industry across the '70s. Is good enough okay, or have I spent too much time trying to make it perfect? The latter is like chasing your tail.



My quality reference point for Maude, the BN1 project, was the body work completed when she was new at the Jensen Motors Factory. For example, the inner body panels appear in the right places, either spot welded or straight stick/mig welded and the weld splatter is plenty, but if you look at the work completed on the left side and compare it to the right, there are differences. Welds are in different places; panels have been hammered flat to fit, or the corners nipped off because, without it, it wouldn't have fitted, but it's only required on the driver's side. In short, it's a bit rough!

I get it, we are talking about a British car production line in 1954. The chassis comes in one end, metal work is welded together using jigs to form sub-assemblies and those sub-assemblies are fixed to the chassis, which then moves on to the next workstation

for workers to perform their tasks. Cost and time were important and as long as the finished product is dimensionally correct, a bit of roughness on something you will never see once the car is complete doesn't matter. I have had the odd sneaky peek at other club member's cars and they appear the same, a bit on the sloppy side, with the exception of the "concour" restored cars; they are nigh on perfect. If I could complete my restoration and get somewhere between a 1954 factory-assembled and a professionally restored car, I would be fairly happy with that.

The work on Maude in the previous month was almost non-existent. The Central Coast chapter workshop for October will be held in my shed. Panic had set in, I needed to lift my game and address my work ethic. There was metal cutting a plenty, as I removed some of that "lacy rufous well-oxidised iron" and slipped in some fresh metal. I am surprised the neighbours still give me a smile and a wave, as I have been frenzied with the hammer and grinder late into the night, every night, for the past month. I'm prepared. Come workshop day, I will be able to nonchalantly present my efforts and casually discuss the intricate points of weld removal using a worn-out flap disc. No one needs to know my varying levels of manic behaviour as I fitted the inner sill, footwell and floor sections. The disturbing part is I haven't started the driver's side. What joy!

Until the next update. Ian





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The Opal Fossicker

Charlie's Run - 20-27 March 2024



It's been a while since we had a Charlie's Run that wasn't aimed at getting us to a National Rally, even to one that didn't happen as in Mildura 2021. AHOC NSW hosted the National Rally this year, and somehow amongst the demands of that event, my travels to visit grand-daughters, and other club runs there wasn't an appropriate week to hold a 2023 Charlie's Run. However, you don't have to wait much longer for the next Charlie's Run.



When I look at the map of NSW it seems that we have visited most places at least once, and quite a few several times. There is though, a gap in the map of our trips where I don't think the club has gone before. That is the northwest of the State. So, in 2024 I'm asking you all to join me on a trip to Lightning Ridge. Not only are there black and other opals to be found, but the town also has thermal springs that feed two artesian bore hot water pools, so bring your bathers for a dip. There are of course lots of opal themed things to do, see and buy as well as the John Murray Art Gallery and several opal mining museums including one built out of bottles, and that's all just within the township.

As usual we will take a reasonably relaxed tour, both to get there and to return. Our provisional schedule is as follows:

Wednesday, 20 March – Travel to Orange.

Thursday, 21 March – Orange to Gilgandra with a detour via the Orange wine region.

Friday, 22 March – Arrive at Lightning Ridge for a three-night stay to enjoy fossicking, exploring and

checking out the opals and other delights.

Monday, 25 March - Depart Lightning Ridge for Gunnedah.

Tuesday, 26 March - Overnight at Denman, hopefully with a last night dinner included.

Wednesday, 27 March - Home.

This should mean that we will be driving for three to four hours each day leaving time for a leisurely lunch and to have an afternoon stroll around each new town.

The cost of this run will be around \$700 per person in a double or twin room for the seven nights' accommodation excluding meals.



Since Covid, few motels seem to have functioning restaurants these days, hence meals will be for you to decide at most locations. I have picked motels close to town facilities wherever possible, so you shouldn't need to drive to dinner. Currently I'm hoping to organise at least a final night dinner, although the motel won't commit to that just yet.

To book your place email or call Gordon (gordonl@aussiebb.com.au or 0403 198 343) and don't forget to pay your deposit of \$50 per person to the club by EFT, including your name and reference 'Opal'.

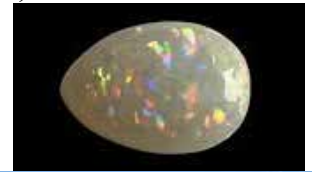
If you can't add a text reference, most banks will allow you to add a numeric reference so please use your club membership number or, if you don't know that, your postcode, to help me identify your payment.

Charlie's Run con't

If you are not able to make an EFT, please deposit a cheque at your local Westpac bank payable to the Austin-Healey Owners Club NSW account detailed below and let Gordon know that you have done so by email or phone.

Westpac Bank: BSB 032 669, A/c no. 277411
'AHOC Charlies Run'

Happy Healeyding,
Gordon Lynas



Waterproof Cover

Thanks to Andrew James

A few months back AHOC member Andrew James asked if I knew of anywhere he could find a waterproof cover for his 100/6.

We discussed all the usual places, including having one specifically made for his car.

After some searching Andrew found one on Amazon in the US for Aus\$157. Being an Amazon Prime member Andrew received free shipping.

Andrew advises that he ordered size C1 and is happy with the quality and fit.

If interested have a look at:-

https://www.amazon.com.au/dp/B0BQ6H7JWV/ref=pe_2419092_287159502_TE_slc_n_id?th=1



- EzyShade 10-Layer Waterproof Sports Car Cover. See Vehicle Size-Chart for Accurate Fit. All Weather Full Outdoor Covers. Miata Porsche SLK Z3 Z4 Classic Cars. Sun Snow Rain. Size C1 (See Size Chart)
Sold by EzyShade



An Enjoyable Austin-Healey trip away, but watch out for the dreaded “Speedo No Go.”

by Allan Whitehouse

One of the enjoyable things about retirement is being able to jump in the car and get away to somewhere pleasant for a few days. Nicer still, is when the car is an Austin-Healey, and you are accompanied by good friends in theirs’.

Such was the case recently when Jo and I planned a three-day, mid-week trip to the NSW Hunter Valley with Carol and Russell Kelly. The weather was a perfect 24°C as the BJ7 and BJ8 cruised up the M1 motorway on our way north, stopping for a light lunch at the Rusty Udder Bar in Wyong, before continuing on to our accommodation at The Mercure Resort Hunter Valley Gardens.



Arriving mid-afternoon, we had time to spend a couple of hours at the McGuigan Wines cellar door located right next to our lodgings, where we sampled a range of their quality products in a relaxed and friendly atmosphere. Mindful of the limited space in the 3000s, we nevertheless purchased a selection of reds and whites to take back home.

At dinner that night we decided on the next day’s activities, so after breakfast we headed off to Petersons Wines in Mount View, where again we were the only ones in attendance, and enjoyed the undivided attention of the staff, keen to ensure our tasting experience was memorable. Next on our list was Peterson House for cuvee tasting (can’t call it “champagne” these days). Making our way back to The Mercure, we decided to call into Vamp by Lisa McGuigan. As it happened, the cellar door was closed for stock-taking that afternoon, but on hearing the wonderful



sound of the Austin-Healeys driving into the carpark, Lisa sent her manager out to invite us in. We spend a most entertaining hour in her unique and quirky company, tasting delicious wines and viewing her “bondage room”, where all manner of dinner parties are held.

Dinner that evening comprised an array of cheeses, biscuits, nuts and breads as we sat on our outdoor deck under a clear sky, savouring selected shiraz and chardonnay wines from our recent acquisitions. For breakfast on our final day, we stopped off at Café Enzo, a delightful establishment only a few minutes from The Mercure. Our last port of call was to Audrey Wilkinson Winery, located atop a foothill of the Broke Back Mountain Ranges (careful – not that other mountain which sounds similar!), and whose history of winemaking dates back 150 years. There was a long wait for wine tasting, so instead we perused the small museum displaying early wine-making tools and equipment plus a pictorial presentation of the development of this company from its inception.



Trip Away cont'

All too soon, our short but exciting adventure was over, and we began the journey back to the routine of life at home.

But wait, trouble-free times away in the 3000 would normally be unthinkable. And true to form that was the case on this trip. Let me explain... when I'm driving, I regularly glance at the dashboard instruments to give me warm comfort that all is operating as it should. About half-way to the Hunter, I noticed that the speedo was reading zero. Rather than relying on the speedo to check my actual speed, I use the rev counter, as I know my BJ7 with its 3.5 diff does 40kph per thousand revs in top overdrive. However, what I do need the speedo to show me is the trip meter reading. Forget your EVs, I get a bad case of range anxiety when the distance covered on a full tank is nearing 250 miles. There aren't many service stations in the Hunter region, but Russell and I did manage to locate one, duly filled up and both made it home without embarrassment.

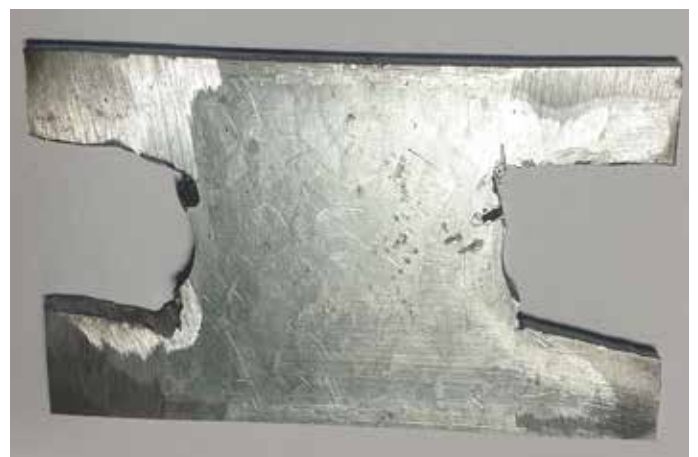


Somehow thinking the issue could be fixed with a simple speedo cable replacement, I ordered one from The Healey Factory. Instead of fitting the new cable entirely, I tried swapping just the inner cables. That didn't work. I disconnected the cable from the back of the speedo and took the car for a run, noticing that the inner cable was in fact turning. I then removed the carpet and tunnel cover, undid the cable from the angled adapter, and using an electric drill (slow speed and anti-clockwise), got the speedo to register. So why was the speedo itself not working?



I next removed the gear assembly and adapter from the overdrive unit, and on inspection found that the short length of internal connecting cable was badly twisted, so I thought AT LAST I had found the problem. Seeking additional technical advice I contacted Geoff Smith, Colin Rule and then Bill Ritchie (ex-Olympic Instruments). I thought if I made a short replacement cable for the twisted section it might work, and when inserted into the adapter it did turn the inner speedo cable, but when connected up to the speedo instrument itself, it failed to operate. To my mind this whole exercise totally defied the laws of mechanical sense. Just as I reached this stage of frustration, Jo happened to walk through the garage and asked how I was progressing, so I tried to explain in simple terms the irrational nature of the Austin-Healey 3000 speedo system of operation. Using her "outside-the-box" insight, she pointed to the angle drive and said: "I reckon that's your problem". Damn, she was right!

Another call to The Healey Factory and a couple of days later I had a brand-new speedometer angle drive. Interestingly, included with the supplied part was a copy of a document dated February 29th 1968, sent out to distributors and dealers explaining the reputation for the original angle drive being prone to premature failure from excessive end load was the omission of a "washer-adapter to gearbox" (see copies next page). I didn't find any such washer in the faulty adapter I removed, and as my BJ7 was built in 1963 I think it did well to survive 50 years of use.

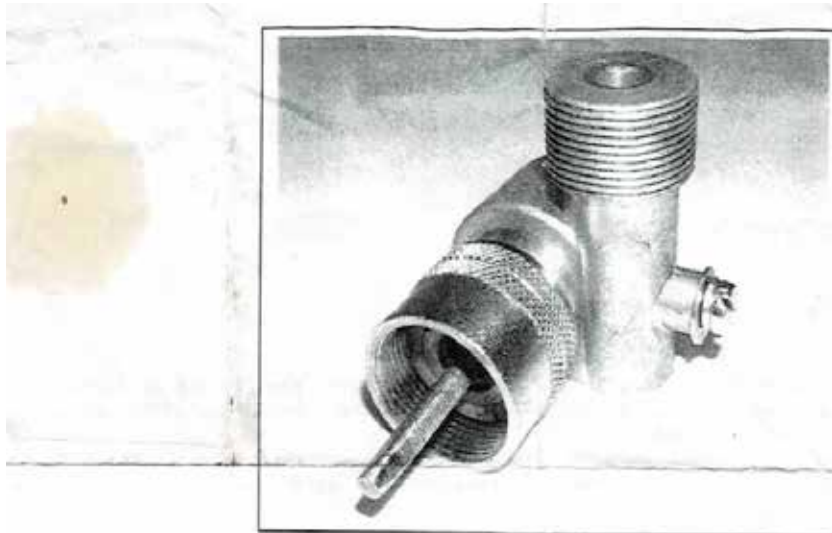


Trip Away cont'

One final problem I had, was to undo the screwed connecting piece from the old angle drive which had seized. I did not have a spanner which would fit in the small gap available, so I made my own using a piece of flat steel bar and an angle grinder. (See photo previous page).

I am pleased to say that the new unit has now been fitted, the Austin-Healey test-driven, and the speedo is working as it should.

Am I looking forward to the next Austin-Healey getaway? You bet I am!



This speedometer angle drive was fitted to many British cars where there was insufficient room to run the speedometer cable directly into the gearbox. The original angle drives quickly developed a reputation for being prone to failure. This resulted in a thorough investigation that in the end resulted in the Technical Service Bulletin (TSB) of February 29, 1968. The TSB (copy on the next page) explains that the 324-720 or 3H550 "washer-adaptor to gearbox" *must* be fitted with the angle drive. If the washer is left out, the end load on the angle drive will be excessive and it will fail. When we first offered our reproduction of the 120694 angle drive, we included information in the catalog and with the part regarding the necessity for the washer.

We also assumed (incorrectly, as it turned out) that the angle drive being replaced would probably have the necessary washer, which could be transferred to the new angle drive. Despite our best efforts to get the word out, a significant number of new angle drives were fitted without the washer. It became apparent that the best thing to do would be to simply include the 324-720 or 3H550 washer with the angle drive, and explain why it was needed.

IMPORTANT! When fitting the angle drive, fit a 324-720 or 3H550 washer as shown on the next page.

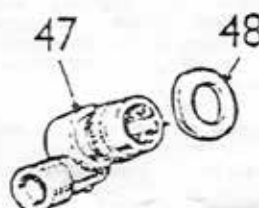
February 29, 1968

TO ALL DISTRIBUTORS AND DEALERS

Re: Right Angled Speedometer Adaptor Failures

Repeated failures of the above have, in many instances, been caused by Washer-Adaptor to gearbox Part Number 3H 550 not being fitted when a new right angled drive adaptor is installed.

This causes an excessive end load and premature failure of the right angled drive pinion.



WASHER 3H 550





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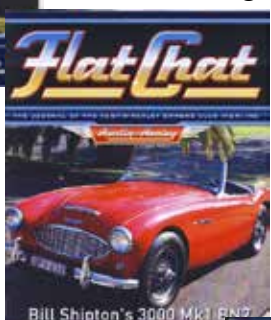
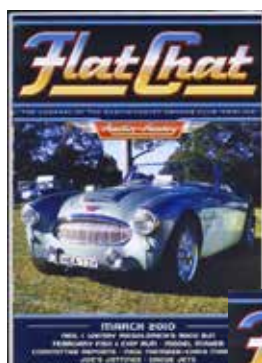
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"Wongaburra"
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NSW 2758

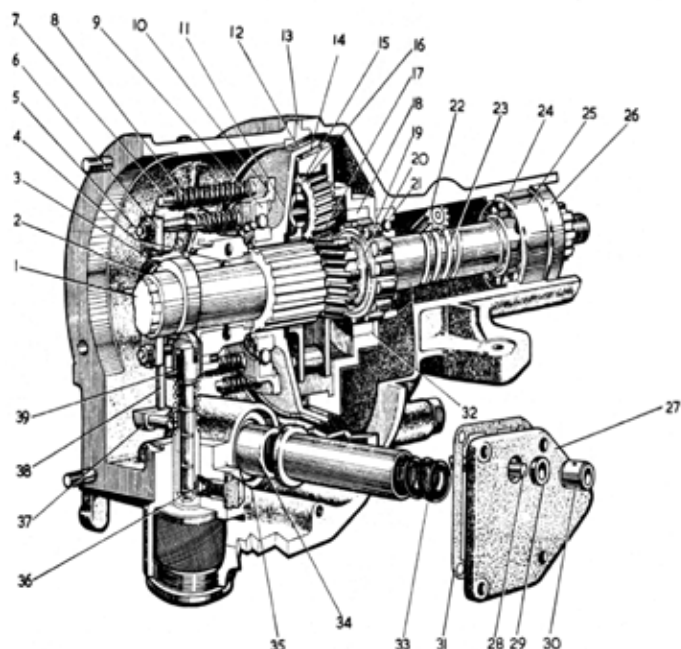
You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



Laycock de Normanville: The ins and outs of overdrive

by Andrew English
(Courtesy Hagerty.co.uk)

THE LAYCOCK DE NORMANVILLE OVERDRIVE UNIT




Tough?

"You'd better believe it," says Tom Cox, transmission expert at Pete Cox Sportscars, where he works along with his father.

"We had one customer who lent his racing Triumph TR6 to a friend for a race at Brands Hatch. He didn't really understand what an overdrive was all about and at maximum revs at the end of the pit straight, he simply clicked it out before Paddock Hill bend. The gearbox instantly saw about 9000 rpm; we did the maths. It completely detonated. There wasn't anything salvageable, but the overdrive, well, that was fine. We took it apart and put it back together—nothing wrong at all."

Tough, then, but also ingenious and ubiquitous, the Laycock de Normanville (LdN) overdrive might sound a bit like the transmission equivalent of the Duckworth-Lewis equation, but while it's not as good at determining the result of a rained-off cricket match, it's quite brilliant at reducing stress on you and your car when motorway cruising.

It was invented in 1948 by Edgar de Normanville, an engineer, inventor, and motoring correspondent for The Motor magazine and The Daily Express. He'd already designed a four-speed epicyclic transmission for Humber when he came up with the similarly geared two-speed overdrive unit, which was built by Laycock Engineering in Sheffield. The LdN overdrive was one of a variety of overdrive units, including those from BorgWarner and Fairey, but it was by far the most popular, with an estimated 3.5 million units built over a 40-year period. LdN overdrives saw service on a variety of cars of the 1950s, '60s, and '70s: Jaguars, Land Rovers, Rovers, Bristols, Austin-Healeys, MGs, Triumphs, Volvos, AMCs, Chevrolets, and even a Ferrari, the 250 GT 2+2.

An overdrive unit is essentially a two-speed mechanically/hydraulically activated epicyclic gear system, which is shaped like a misshapen football and bolted to the back of the gearbox driving the propeller shaft. Overdrive simply means gearing that provides a tall enough ratio to enable the output shaft of the gearbox to spin faster than its input. Think of the engine 'over driving' the propeller shaft.

OD cont'

So why did cars need overdrives at all? Post-WWII motoring marked a profound change as more middle-class motorists bought cars and travelled farther on very different roads. There were just 383,525 cars on the road in 1923, over a million in 1930, more than 2.5 million by 1950, and just under 5 million in 1960. To enable motorists to travel farther faster, in the 1950s the UK government undertook a program of mass road building to enable a 20th century car-based economy. Britain's first dual carriageway had opened at the London end of the Great West Road in 1925, but the 1950s and '60s saw their widespread adoption. In December 1958, the Preston Bypass, Britain's first-ever motorway, was opened by Prime Minister Harold Macmillan, who quoted Robbie Burns: "I'm now arrived—thanks to the gods! Thro' pathways rough and muddy. A certain sign that makin' roads is no this people's study."



Harold MacMillan inspects the Preston By-Pass



The M1 shortly after opening.

The following year, the first stretch of the M1 opened and cars subjected to the stresses of fast, continuous use on these new roads required a rethink. Better engine bearings, for instance, which could survive that stress, as well as improvements to cooling, better suspension and tyres, and lower cruising revs. With sufficient torque from the engine, fitting an overdrive meant that cars and trucks with longitudinally mounted engines and three- and four-speed gearboxes could drive on these long, straight roads with the engine turning at lower revolutions, which reduced fuel consumption, wear, noise and vibration.

Of course, there was always the option of an over-driven fifth gear, which does much the same thing as an overdrive unit, and that's exactly where we've ended up today with five- and six-speed gearboxes, which reduce the gearing to improve emissions and fuel consumption. In the 1950s and '60s, however, a five-speed gearbox could be problematic. Designing and manufacturing a five-speed is neither simple nor cheap; witness today where carmakers often hand off their transmission business to firms such as BorgWarner, Dana, Getrag, Voith, Aisin, or ZF and therefore effectively share the cost with other manufacturers.

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OD Con't

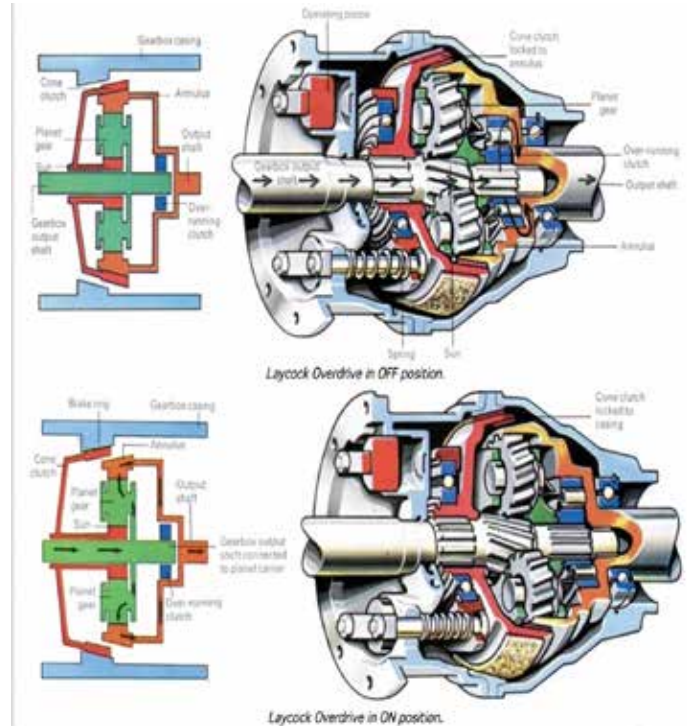
And, as James Brearley, engineer and director of Overdrive Repair Services in Sheffield says: "That fifth speed would sit at the back of the gearbox, and would need a method to engage it with different shift rods and forks, and there often isn't the space to accommodate them at the rear of the 'box."

So, for the more outward-bound motorist, an overdrive unit it was. And what are those mysterious parts that fill the misshapen football at the back of the gearbox? The basic overdrive parts are the pump, which runs off the gearbox output shaft to build hydraulic pressure, and the solenoid, which opens a valve and allows high-pressure oil to reach the operating pistons, which in turn bear on a cone clutch that locks the epicyclic gearing and engages the taller overdrive ratio.



Although the epicyclic movement of the planets was described in Greek literature and used to illustrate the orbits of those planets, it took the industrial revolution for a generation of engineers to appreciate the benefits of epicyclic gearing: high-speed transmission reduction, with low vibration and relative low cost.

An epicyclic gear system comprises one or more outer planet gears revolving around a central or sun gear, with the planet gears mounted on a carrier, which rotates relative to the sun gear. It's ingenious and efficient and strong, but complex. I rebuilt the gearbox of my old Triumph, but entrusted the overdrive to a specialist reckoning it was a load of voodoo engineering.



A glimpse at the 'voodoo' taking place in an OD unit (uniquecarsandparts.com.au)

"Yes, there is a certain amount of voodoo in there," admits Brearley, "though the operating principles are fairly straightforward. They all had their own way of building pressure."

Initially the LdN overdrive was produced as an A-Type unit. "It has a hydraulic pump unit which built up to 340 to 550psi," explains Brearley. "That stored pressure, when released, pushed the cone clutch into the brake ring, which stopped the sun gear and sent the drive round the epicyclic gears. In the earliest days the overdrive was controlled by a mechanical lever. The 12-volt solenoid came later."

Brearley says the A-Type unit had a couple of different ratios, expressed as the percentage reduction in engine revs for a given speed: 22 percent for most Triumphs and 28 percent for Jaguars and Austin-Healeys.

By around 1972, the old A-Types were replaced by the J-Type, which had a slightly different mounting system (more to the rear of the car) and different overall gearing drop. Internet warriors rage about the relative strengths of the A versus J, the latter having smaller gears, fewer moving parts, different hydraulics, which subject the gears to less force, and more accessible hydraulics when mounted in the car.

OD cont'

Different vehicle applications have different adaptor plates and output shafts, and there were also special application overdrives: D-Types for early Triumphs, MGBs, and Hillmans; LH Types for MGBs and Ford-engined vehicles such as the Zephyr and Reliant Scimitar; and the P-Types, which were the last built and fitted to Volvos, keeping the faith in the trusty overdrive by taking over a million units from Laycock.

Here is evidence of efficiency—
Extract from
 "MOTOR" Road test 8/32 May 28/1952, of a current production car of 2,088 c.c.

FUEL CONSUMPTION.

	Direct top	In overdrive
	M.P.G.	M.P.G.
Car driven at constant 30 m.p.h.	29.5	33 = 11%
" " " " 40 m.p.h.	27.0	31.5 = 16½%
" " " " 50 m.p.h.	24.0	29.5 = 23%
" " " " 60 m.p.h.	21.0	25.0 = 19%
" " " " 70 m.p.h.	17.5	20.5 = 17%

ROAD SPEED

K.P.H.	M.P.H.	1st	2nd Norm.	2nd + OD.	Top Norm.	Top + OD.
16	10	1250	790	—	558	—
32	20	2500	1580	—	1116	—
48	30	3750	2370	—	1674	—
64	40	5000	3160	2460	2232	1735
80	50	—	3950	3070	2790	2170
96	60	—	4790	3680	3348	2605
112	70	—	—	4290	3906	3040
128	80	—	—	4900	4464	3475
144	90	—	—	—	5022	3910
160	100	—	—	—	—	4345
176	110	—	—	—	—	4780

There were other advantages of the overdrive, too, not least that of providing additional ratios, especially the early A-Type units, which would operate on second, third, and fourth gears. This effectively gave the early TRs seven forward ratios, although third overdrive was so close to fourth as to be practically the same. And some applications, such as the Triumph GT6, gave no advantage in lower engine revs since the £58 special-order overdrive on the 1966 two-seat coupé gave a 0.802 overdriven ratio on third and fourth gears. But it was also accompanied by a final-drive ratio change from 3.27:1 to 3.89:1, which not only required speedo gear change, but also effectively gave the same overall gearing of about 21mph per 1000rpm as the standard four-speed model. So, in this case, the overdrive unit gave substantially better acceleration through the gears over the non-overdrive car.

My own experience is that a LdN overdrive is a reliable if slightly leaky device, and most problems stem from the wiring to the solenoid and neglect of not changing the gearbox oil. Overdrive Repair Services' Brearley concurs, but says that there are issues with side plates, which come under incredible forces, or the A-Type adaptor plates, which see the same from hydraulic and spring pressure. "It's unbelievable the

pressure those plates have to stand up to, and they bend and crack, so we've made up our own stronger items," he says.

Similarly with linings for the cone clutch, which have had to be remanufactured over the years. Original linings had asbestos content and the new, non-asbestos linings have slightly more grippy characteristics, which means faster and more brutal engagement, which some customers don't like.



Connected to a Volvo gearbox.

"The clutch has to stop that inertia at quite high engine revs," says Brearley, "and there's a slip time which includes the clutch travel and the return rate. If you allow too much slip time, the material can get quite hot quite quickly, so we have to be quite careful. The difference between the clutch thudding in like a ton of bricks and slipping too much can be as little as five-thousands of an inch adjustment."

There's also the thorny subject of the right lubrication for the gearbox and overdrive, which share common oil. All are agreed that the most modern GL5 gear oils should be avoided as they can attack some white and yellow metal bearing material. Older GL4 lubricant can be used, but advice from Duckhams, the TR Register, and from Pete Cox is a straight mineral oil SAE 40 change regularly and with cleaned filters at the same time.



On a Volvo

Compact five-speed gearboxes and transverse engines put paid to the bulky overdrive, and Laycock closed down in 1970s. "It was a brutal process," says Brearley. "Specialist machines worth hundreds of thousands and endless overdrive units all went in the skip." Overdrive Repair Services was born out of that closure and formed by former Laycock engineer Joe Winter in 1986, building on the winding down of Laycock's repair and spares service. His son Paul joined the company soon after along with Peter Eggington, another former Laycock engineer. "We're not the only firm looking after Laycock overdrives,"

says Brearley, "but we like to think we do a good job."

It's easy to see overdrives as heavy and complicated sources of potential breakdown, but however it alters the gearing, in the end, an overdrive is a brilliant driver's aid in an older car. For overtaking, accelerating and holding a ratio between corners, it has no equal, and that flip of the switch on the steering column (or the gear lever) which engages the voodoo and fires the engine's revs up or down in the blink of an eye, is one of the great pleasures of an old car.

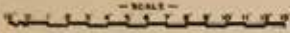
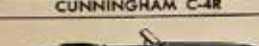
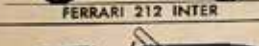
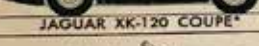
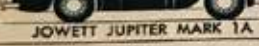
DG 95 - Private Rally 100/6

'DG 95', was owned and rallied in period by Don Grimshaw, who at one time also owned the ex-works Austin-Healeys 'UOC 741' and 'SMO 745'. It incorporated many 'Works only' modifications, indicating at the very least that it was worked on by BMC's Competitions Department at various times. In 1962, Don Grimshaw drove 'DG 95' in the Monte

Carlo Rally, finishing 31st, and the following year entered the car in various national events in the UK, including the Yorkshire Rally. In 1965 he competed in four international rallies with 'DG 95': Monte Carlo, Geneva, East African Safari and Spa-Sofia-Liège.



Your Last Page

SPORTS CARS AND HOT RODS		SPORTS CAR SPECIFICATIONS							
	TYPE OF ENGINE	DISPLACEMENT		BORE AND STROKE		BRAKE HORSEPOWER AND RPM	COMPRESSION RATIO	TORQUE, LBS.-FT. AND RPM	GEARS
		CU. IN.	CC	IN.	MM				
 ALFA-ROMEO DISCO VOLANTE	6 CYL OHC	140	2,295	3.22 X 3.55	82.6 X 91	200 @ ?	8:1	NA	4 SM
 ALLARD PALM BEACH	OPT 4 OR 6 CYL OHV	OPT	OPT	OPT	OPT	47 @ 4,400 AND 68 @ 4,000	6.8:1	DEPEND-ING ON ENGINE	3 SM
 ALLARD K-3	OPT V-8	OPT	OPT	OPT	OPT	OPT	OPT	DEPEND-ING ON ENGINE	3 SM
 ASTON-MARTIN DB2 COUPE	6 CYL TWIN OHC	157.6	2,580	3.07 X 3.54	78 X 90	123 @ 5,000	8.5:1	125 @ 3,100	4 SM
 AUSTIN HEALEY 100	4 CYL OHV	162	2,660	3.44 X 4.38	87.3 X 111	90 @ 4,000	7.5:1	144 @ 2,000	3 SM WITH OD
 CUNNINGHAM C-4R	V-8 CHRYSLER	331	5,424	3.8 X 3.6	96.5 X 91.4	300 @ 5,200	7.5:1	350 @ 4,400	5 SM
 FERRARI 212 INTER	V-12 *	156.6	2,562	2.7 X 2.23	68 X 58.8	170 @ 6,500	8:1	NA	5 SM
 JAGUAR XK-120 ROADSTER*	6 CYL TWIN OHC	210	3,442	3.27 X 4.17	83 X 106	160 @ 5,000	7:1 OR 8:1	195 @ 2,500	4 SM
 JAGUAR XK-120 COUPE*	6 CYL TWIN OHC	210	3,442	3.27 X 4.17	83 X 106	160 @ 5,200	7:1 OR 8:1	195 @ 2,500	4 SM
 JOWETT JUPITER MARK 1A	4 CYL OHV	91	1,486	2.85 X 3.54	72.5 X 90	62.5 @ 4,500	8:1	84 @ 3,000	4 SM
 AUSTIN HEALEY 100	4 CYL OHV	155	2,496	3.35 X 4.33	85 X 110	100 @ 4,000	7:1	NA	4 SM

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